

90-Day GTM Activation Plan

Operations Partner Positioning

Bandwidth-optimized approach for HC3's small marketing team

Direct Answer to Kristan's Question

"If HC3 were your company and resources were tight, what would you protect at all costs, and what would you scale back?"

Protect: Customer warm-up (top 10 only), leadership alignment, operations-focused website launch, one customer case study, basic sales enablement. These five elements create the minimum viable launch that protects revenue and establishes operational discipline positioning.

Scale back: Benchmark study (defer 6 months), multiple analyst briefings (focus on one), content volume (2-3 operational solution pages, not six), press outreach (let momentum build organically), webinars (optional only if clear capacity and ROI).

Why this works: You get market validation and customer protection without overwhelming the team. The operations partner positioning gets established, sales gets equipped, and momentum builds naturally rather than artificially.

Priority Matrix

Protect at All Costs (Core Operations Partner Launch)

- **Leadership alignment session** – Without exec alignment, nothing else works

- **Customer warm launch to top 10 accounts** – Cut from 20 to 10, focus on strongest relationships
- **Operations-focused website launch** – Must-have for credibility
- **One hero customer case study** – Proof point for operational discipline expertise
- **Sales enablement basics** – Operations partner one-pager + specialized work positioning

Execute If Bandwidth Allows (High Impact, Manageable)

- **Jack Henry SSO coordinated launch** – Leverage existing partnership momentum
- **One analyst briefing** – Focus on Aite-Novarica, strongest HC3 relationship
- **LinkedIn cadence from Tori** – Weekly posts using operational discipline messaging framework
- **Trade event appearance** – If already committed, optimize messaging

Defer or Scale Back (Nice-to-Have)

- **Benchmark study** – Resource-intensive, delay to Q1 2027
- **Multiple analyst briefings** – Cut from 3 to 1, focus quality over quantity
- **All operational solution content** – Launch with 2-3, add others in Q4
- **Weekly content from Jeremiah** – Monthly instead, higher quality

Optional (Bandwidth Permitting)

- **Webinars** – Only if team capacity allows and clear ROI. Not required for operations partner positioning success

90-Day Timeline (Bandwidth-Optimized)

Phase 1: Days 1-30. Foundation and Internal Alignment

Focus: Get the foundation right before going external. Sequential execution to avoid overwhelming the team.

Week 1-2: Internal Foundation

- **Leadership alignment session.** 90 minutes with exec team. BrandThnk facilitates, minimal HC3 prep required.
- **Sales enablement package.** Operations partner one-pager + specialized work positioning. HC3 creates with positioning framework from BrandThnk.
- **Website content development.** HC3 develops operations-focused pages using BrandThnk positioning framework and messaging guidelines.

Week 3-4: Customer Foundation

- **Customer warm launch (top 10 accounts only).** Kristan and Tori brief strongest relationships. Target: 2-3 willing to provide quotes.
- **One customer case study development.** HC3 team interviews and writes case study using BrandThnk messaging framework. HC3 coordinates customer approval.
- **Internal all-hands.** 30-minute session. Operations partner positioning + Q&A. Everyone can explain HC3's specialized operational role in 60 seconds.

Phase 2: Days 31-60. Focused Public Launch

Focus: High-impact, low-resource activities. Quality over quantity.

Week 5-6: Operations Partner Launch

- **Website goes live.** New operations partner messaging, 2-3 operational solution pages (not all six), customer case study.
- **Soft launch.** LinkedIn post from Tori using operational discipline messaging framework. Customer quote block. No press release initially.
- **Sales team activation.** One training session on operations partner positioning. Account teams begin retention conversations.

Week 7-8: Targeted Amplification

- **Jack Henry SSO coordinated launch** (if timing aligns). Leverage existing partnership momentum.
- **One analyst briefing** with Aite-Novarica. Focus on quality relationship over quantity.
- **LinkedIn content cadence.** Weekly from Tori, monthly from Jeremiah. Use operational discipline messaging framework for consistent voice.

Phase 3: Days 61-90. Proof and Rhythm

Focus: Generate proof points while establishing sustainable operating rhythm.

Week 9-10: Customer Proof

- **Install-base retention focus.** Sales team uses operations partner positioning in renewal conversations. Track adjacent operational solution attach opportunities.
- **Customer success integration.** Customer success team incorporates operations partner positioning into regular touchpoints.

Week 11-12: Event and Content

- **Trade event appearance** (if already committed). Retrofit messaging, don't add new events.
- **Additional operational solution content** as bandwidth allows. Target: 1-2 more pages, not all six.
- **90-day readout to exec team.** What worked, what didn't, next 90 days scope and resource requirements.

What We're NOT Doing (To Protect Bandwidth)

- **Benchmark study** – Defer to Q1 2027
- **Webinars** – Optional only if clear capacity and ROI
- **Three analyst briefings** – Focus on one quality relationship
- **All operational solution content** – Launch with 2-3, add others as capacity allows
- **Multiple press placements** – Let momentum build organically

Success Metrics (Bandwidth-Appropriate)

- **Revenue protection:** Install-base retention rate maintains or improves
- **Positioning adoption:** 80% of sales team can position HC3 as operations partner for critical work
- **Customer validation:** 3-5 customers willing to provide operational discipline quotes
- **Market perception:** One positive analyst mention or customer reference
- **Internal alignment:** Exec team consistently uses operations partner language in external settings

Strategic Context: Sticky Note Approach with Operators Mindset

This plan reflects HC3's strategic shift to "sticky note approach" with operators mindset.

Core positioning: HC3 is the operations partner for community banks and credit unions whose most operationally critical work is too important to get wrong. Statements anchor the work; everything HC3 extends into sits operationally next to them.

What changed: Focus shifted to specialized operational solutions that solve specific "sticky note problems." Emphasis on "work that sits outside the core's scope" and operational discipline expertise. HC3 is **NOT a platform, a core system, or a core replacement.**

Key principle: Customer pain map decides fit, not org chart. Discipline over scale. Operational excellence in high-stakes work that FIs can't afford to get wrong.

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